



You might have encountered keyboards with different shapes for the Return (Enter) key. The design choice isn't for aesthetics but to follow standard layouts such as ANSI, ISO and JIS. Under the ISO standard, two backwards L-shaped keys – “bigass” and “BiGass” are also included. We kid you not!

It's quite easy to verify the material of your keycap by rubbing acetone (or nail polish remover) under the keys and checking whether the plastic's surface melts away or not. Since PBT and POM are resistant to chemicals, only ABS keycaps will get damaged.



Out of all the liquids and solutions available, the best way to clean your keyboards stranglely is with water mixed with a few drops of liquid detergent.

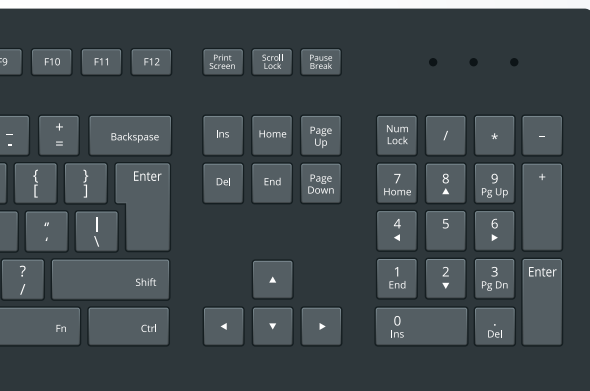
Boiling keys in water is another method to determine the material. ABS keys will deform while PBT keycaps won't.

If you're shopping for keycaps to replace existing ones on your keyboard, and want something to last longer, go for double-shot keycaps. They won't wear out compared to laser engraved or pad printed ones.

Double-shot keycaps can be identified by looking under the key for two plastics used (different colours). You can also look for “sprue” marks at any edge of the key where the plastic was injected.

Burn tests can also determine the type of plastic used. ABS keys will slowly burn in a yellow flame with blue edges. POM keys will burn rapidly, giving off a formaldehyde smell (similar to pickles).

There are layouts other than QWERTY which might help you type faster. Dvorak and Colemak are said to be more scientific than QWERTY and improve your typing speed. Although, it would take some time to adapt to the new layout.



* ABS - Acrylonitrile Butadiene Styrene
 * PBT - Polybutylene Terephthalate
 * POM - Polyoxymethylene